

CLAT 2026 UG — Official Syllabus

Common Law Admission Test | 25 National Law Universities | Offline Pen & Paper Test

■ Key Dates 2026

Event	Date
Registration Opens	1 August 2025
Registration Closes	31 October 2025 (11:59 PM)
Exam Date	Sunday, 7 December 2025 — 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM
PWD Category	Sunday, 7 December 2025 — 2:00 PM to 4:40 PM (+40 min)
Mode	OFFLINE (Pen & Paper) at exam centres across India

■ Exam Pattern

Section	Questions (Approx)	% of Paper	Marks
English Language	22–26	~20%	22–26
Current Affairs & GK	28–32	~25%	28–32
Legal Reasoning	28–32	~25%	28–32
Logical Reasoning	22–26	~20%	22–26
Quantitative Techniques	10–14	~10%	10–14
Total	120	100%	120

Marking: +1 correct / -0.25 wrong / 0 unanswered · Duration: 2 hours · Mode: Offline (OMR/Pen & Paper)

Tie-breaking: Higher marks in Legal Reasoning → Higher age → Computerised draw of lots

■ Eligibility Criteria

Criterion	Requirement
Age Limit	No upper age limit for UG Programme
Minimum Marks	General/OBC: 45% in 10+2 or equivalent SC/ST/PwD: 40% in 10+2 or equivalent
Appearing Candidates	Students appearing in March/April 2026 board exams are also eligible to apply
Application Fee	General/OBC: ■4,000 · SC/ST/BPL/PwD: ■3,500 (online payment only, non-refundable)
Colleges	25 National Law Universities (NLUs) across India including NLU Delhi, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Kolkata etc.
Nationality	Indian Nationals and NRIs (Foreign Nationals not eligible for CLAT)

■ ENGLISH LANGUAGE — 22–26 Questions (~20%)

Format	Passages of ~450 words each (contemporary or historically significant fiction & non-fiction). A 12th standard student can read each passage in 5–7 minutes.
Reading Comprehension	Identify the main point, arguments, and viewpoints discussed in the passage
Inferences & Conclusions	Draw inferences and conclusions based on the passage
Summarisation	Summarise the passage accurately
Compare & Contrast	Compare and contrast different arguments or viewpoints set out in the passage
Vocabulary in Context	Understand the meaning of words and phrases as used in the passage

■ CURRENT AFFAIRS & GENERAL KNOWLEDGE — 28–32 Questions (~25%)

Format	Passages of up to 450 words derived from news, journalistic sources, and non-fiction writing. No prior law knowledge required beyond the passage.
Contemporary Events	Events of significance from India and the world
Arts & Culture	Indian and international arts, literature, culture
International Affairs	Global issues, international organisations, treaties
Historical Events	Events of continuing historical significance
Legal Context	Questions may include legal information discussed in the passage (no extra law knowledge needed)

■■ LEGAL REASONING — 28–32 Questions (~25%)

Format	Passages of ~450 words relating to fact situations, legal matters, public policy, or moral philosophical enquiries. No prior law knowledge required.
Identify Rules & Principles	Identify and infer rules and principles set out in the passage
Apply Rules to Facts	Apply rules and principles to various fact situations given in questions
Change in Rules	Understand how changes to rules may alter their application to different fact scenarios
General Awareness	A general awareness of contemporary legal and moral issues helps (but not mandatory)

■ LOGICAL REASONING — 22–26 Questions (~20%)

Format	Series of short passages (~450 words each) followed by one or more questions
Argument Structure	Recognise an argument, its premises and conclusions
Critical Analysis	Critically analyse patterns of reasoning; assess how conclusions depend on premises
Strengthening/Weakening	How conclusions may be strengthened or weakened by changes in premises
Inferences	Infer what follows from the passage and apply to new situations
Relationships & Analogies	Draw relationships, analogies; identify contradictions and equivalence

■ QUANTITATIVE TECHNIQUES — 10–14 Questions (~10%)

Format	Short sets of facts, propositions, or textual representations of numerical information followed by questions
Numerical Derivation	Derive, infer, and manipulate numerical information from passages
Mathematical Operations	Apply 10th standard mathematics operations on the information
Topics Covered	Ratios and proportions, Basic algebra, Mensuration, Statistical estimation
Note	No advanced mathematics required — 10th standard level is sufficient

■ Preparation Strategy

- Read quality newspapers daily (The Hindu, Indian Express) for Current Affairs & GK
- Practice reading long passages quickly — aim to read 450 words in under 5 minutes
- For Legal Reasoning — practise applying rules to hypothetical scenarios
- For Quantitative Techniques — revise 10th standard Maths (ratios, algebra, mensuration)
- Consortium publishes model papers & sample questions — use them for practice
- No prior law knowledge needed — focus on reasoning and comprehension skills

